

THE MANDOLIN

A Method for Self-Instruction

CHAPTER I.

OF THE INSTRUMENT AND ITS PARTS.

The mandolin is a small instrument of the lute family, having a body shaped like the half of a pear, a short neck with frets, and four pairs of strings tuned in fifths, in the same manner as the violin: G, D, A, E. The strings are set in vibration by a small plectrum of tortoise-shell, held between the thumb and the first finger of the right hand.

The Neapolitan model, now the most common, has a bowl built up of many narrow ribs of maple or rosewood. The Milanese mandolin, with six single strings, is less often met with in this country.

CHAPTER II.

OF HOLDING THE INSTRUMENT.

The player should be seated upon a chair without arms, the body erect, the left foot resting upon a low stool. The instrument is placed upon the right thigh, the neck inclined upward, so that the head is about level with the shoulder.

CHAPTER III.

OF THE PLECTRUM.

The plectrum should be held lightly, the point projecting but a little beyond the finger. In the tremolo, which is the chief charm of the instrument, the strokes follow one another so rapidly that the note appears to be sustained, as upon the violin.